

1839



Parasol poised "against the sun" (*para sol*)

Fullness of sleeve extends to wrist

Blue-grey silk skirt

Pleated blue-grey silk The wide V-shaped neckline of this dress is echoed by the pleating over the sloped shoulders, across the front of the bodice, and into the narrow waist. Lace-edged handkerchiefs were popular accessories.

1840



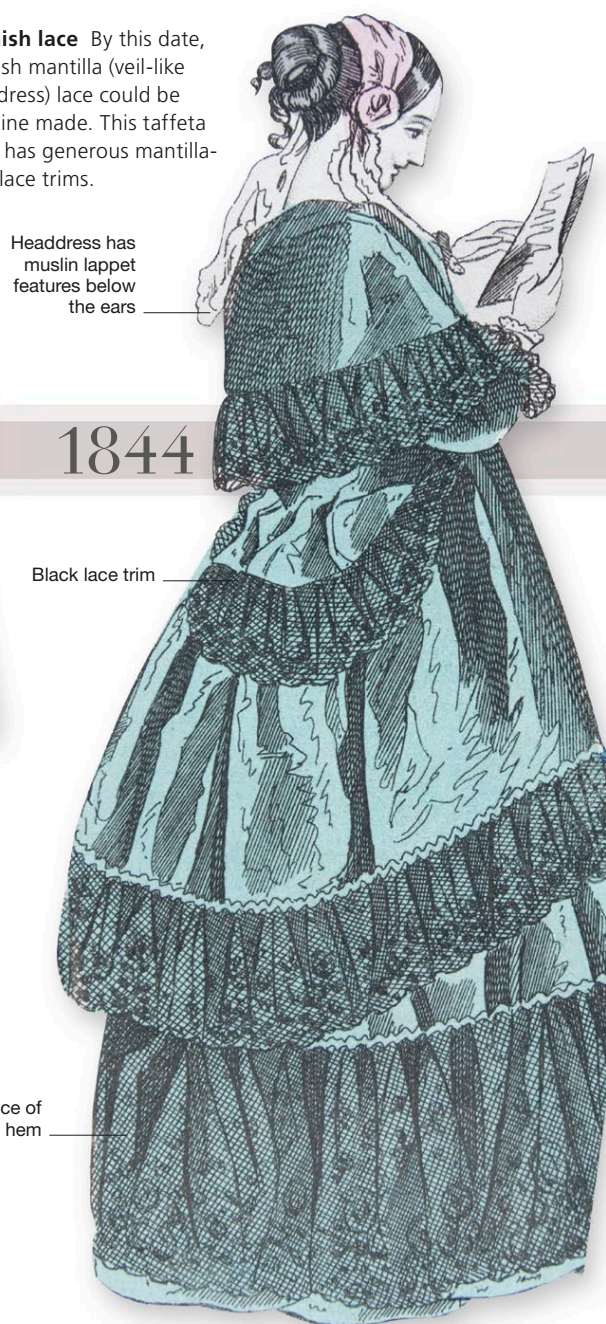
Flowers worn under bonnet

Ermine for warmth in winter

Wide sleeves trimmed with cording bows

Pelisse robe This opulent blue coat, a colour popular during the 1840s, is edged with luxurious ermine. Cording bows on the sleeves are matched at the waist by a belt that is finished with decorative tassels.

1844



Spanish lace By this date, Spanish mantilla (veil-like headdress) lace could be machine made. This taffeta dress has generous mantilla-style lace trims.

Headdress has muslin lappet features below the ears

Black lace trim

Deep flounce of lace at hem

1855



Tiered sleeves

Cashmere shawls were desirable accessories

Flounced, checked skirt



Sloping shoulder seams restrain arm movement

Hair is parted at the centre

Tartan flounces This checked dress reflects the popularity of Queen Victoria's new Scottish palace, Balmoral, and the ensuing vogue for tartan. The flounces of the skirt are cut on the bias to create a diamond-shape pattern.

Wedding, confirmation, or party dress The flounced sleeves and skirt with central diaper pattern panel are both trimmed with yellow ribbons and *broderie anglaise*. The hair is outlined with pink ribbon, in Italian style.

BONNETS

Bonnets of fabric or straw were worn outside to keep delicate complexions fashionably pale. They were fastened under the chin with ribbons and decorated with frills, lace, ribbons, silk flowers, and feathers.

The wide-brimmed bonnets of the 1830s were gradually replaced with more closely fitting headwear shaped to cover the cheeks in the 1840s, like the straw bonnet here.

Silk bonnet

Straw bonnet